

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

JUNE 19, 2026

Geneva Postponed

Holiday Edition — Chips ripped Thursday on Iran-deal optimism; Friday's Bürgenstock talks called off as VP Vance dropped travel; Juneteenth closes US equities and bonds.

S&P 500 (THU CLOSE)	NASDAQ (THU CLOSE)	BRENT (BNO THU)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	FEAR & GREED
\$746.74 · ↑0.78%	\$740.62 · ↑2.51%	\$43.88 · ↑0.90%	~\$63K · soft heading into Juneteenth weekend	~37 · Fear (CNN, Jun 18 read; drop fell back to Crypto at 14)

SECTION 01

Markets — Chips Rip Into a Closed Friday

THURSDAY DELIVERED A SHARP CHIP-LED RECOVERY FROM THE POST-FOMC DRAWDOWN PER THE DATA DROP — THE NASDAQ PROXY CLOSED AT \$740.62 (↑2.51%), THE S&P 500 PROXY AT \$746.74 (↑0.78%), AND THE RUSSELL 2K PROXY AT \$295.59 (↑1.97%) WHILE THE DOW PROXY WAS AN OUTLIER AT \$515.52 (↓0.15%), PRESSURED BY LMT ↓4.01% AND GD ↓3.53% ON THE REPORTED PEACE-DEAL NARRATIVE PER THE DATA DROP'S LMT AND GD NEWS RUNS — THE SEMICONDUCTOR COHORT LED: CRDO ↑9.02% TO \$271.83, MRVL ↑7.27% TO \$310.58, TSM ↑6.94% TO \$462.12, QCOM ↑6.17% TO \$226.11, NXPI ↑5.05% TO \$313.27, AMD ↑4.86% TO \$537.37, ADI ↑4.83% TO \$434.46, LRCX ↑3.97% TO \$389.04, KEYS ↑3.70%, VST ↑3.10%, NVDA ↑2.95% — UVXY (VOL PROXY) CLOSED ↓5.25% TO \$26.00 PER THE DATA DROP

The session was the cleanest expression yet of the bifurcation Carson has anchored across recent briefs: per Reuters coverage cited via the data drop's headline run ("Stocks Sharply Higher as US-Iran Peace Deal Eases Inflation Risks"), equities rallied on the Iran-framework execution narrative, while the defense cohort drew separation as a reciprocal trade. Per the data drop, sector dispersion was emphatic: XLK ↑3.04%, XLY ↑1.45%, XLI ↑0.73% led, while XLE ↓1.65%, XLF ↓0.89%, and XLV ↓0.87% trailed. TLT ↑0.49% to \$86.75 per the data drop accompanied a curve re-bull-flattening — the 2-year reportedly came in to approximately 4.19% and the 10-year to approximately 4.46% per ETF Trends coverage, partially unwinding Wednesday's hawkish-dot-plot front-end repricing. For FCI's growth book, the chip rip layered onto two distinct catalysts: per the data drop's MRVL news run, Marvell reportedly hit a new high reportedly tied to a Bezos/Amazon-linked decision and an analyst price target hike; per the QCOM news run, Qualcomm extended Tuesday's reported custom-AI-silicon news; and per the data drop's TSM headlines, Intel-related re-rating chatter reportedly added to the foundry tape.

THU CHIP RIP	CRDO ↑9.02% · MRVL ↑7.27% · TSM ↑6.94%
THU CHIP RIP (CONT.)	QCOM ↑6.17% · NXPI ↑5.05% · AMD ↑4.86% · ADI ↑4.83%
DEFENSE DRAG	LMT ↓4.01% · GD ↓3.53% · peace-deal reciprocal trade
SECTOR LEAD	XLK ↑3.04% · XLY ↑1.45% · XLI ↑0.73%
SECTOR DRAG	XLE ↓1.65% · XLF ↓0.89% · XLV ↓0.87%
CURVE (RE-FLATTEN)	2Y ~4.19% · 10Y ~4.46% · TLT ↑0.49%
UVXY (VOL)	\$26.00 · ↓5.25% · vol drained on Iran tape
STLD Q2 GUIDE	\$3.51–\$3.55 vs ~\$4.16 est per StreetInsider · STLD ↓7.49%

FRIDAY IS THE JUNETEENTH FEDERAL HOLIDAY WITH NYSE, NASDAQ, AND THE FULL U.S. BOND MARKET CLOSED PER THE STANDARD EXCHANGE CALENDAR AND SIFMA RECOMMENDATION — TRADING RESUMES MONDAY, JUNE 22 — PER REUTERS COVERAGE IN THE DATA DROP'S HEADLINE RUN, "STOCKS TURN LOWER AS US-IRAN TALKS HIT EARLY

SNAG" FRAMES THE LATE-SESSION TAPE THAT CARRIES INTO THE CLOSED WINDOW

The post-FOMC week ended with the curve re-flattening and the chip cohort recovering, but with a holiday gap layered against an unresolved geopolitical execution — the Bürgenstock postponement disclosed late Thursday (covered in the next section) means Monday's reopen carries Friday's no-show as new information rather than digesting a signed framework. STLD ↓7.49% to \$249.91 per the data drop on the company's reported Q2 EPS guidance of \$3.51–\$3.55 versus a consensus of approximately \$4.16 per StreetInsider and Investing.com coverage of the June 17 guide-down was the day's most notable holdings-specific drawdown; the company reportedly cited an asset write-down on the Arizona-to-Mississippi recycled aluminum slab center relocation. Carson's active SPY \$645.80 support remained materially untouched (Thursday S&P 500 proxy intraday range \$743.86–\$748.23 per the data drop).

The chip cohort recovered Wednesday's post-FOMC drawdown in a single session, then the geopolitical execution stumbled into the closed Friday window. Avoid Erosion.

Geopolitics — Bürgenstock Postponed, Pentagon Asks \$80B

THE FRIDAY JUNE 19 BÜRGENSTOCK TALKS BETWEEN THE UNITED STATES AND IRAN HAVE BEEN POSTPONED PER THE SWISS FOREIGN MINISTRY, REUTERS COVERAGE IN THE DATA DROP'S HEADLINE RUN, AND CNBC, US NEWS & WORLD REPORT, AND TIMES OF ISRAEL COVERAGE — VICE PRESIDENT JD VANCE REPORTEDLY DROPPED TRAVEL PLANS TO SWITZERLAND, WITH A WHITE HOUSE SPOKESPERSON REPORTEDLY CITING “UNRESOLVED LOGISTICS SURROUNDING THE NEXT PHASE OF NEGOTIATIONS” PER MULTIPLE REPORTS — PER THE SWISS FOREIGN MINISTRY STATEMENT CITED VIA REUTERS AND THE DATA DROP'S HEADLINE RUN, THE U.S., IRAN, QATAR, AND PAKISTAN TALKS ARE REPORTEDLY POSTPONED WITHOUT A NEW DATE SET — THE UNDERLYING MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING REPORTEDLY SIGNED DIGITALLY ON JUNE 15 BY TRUMP AND THE IRANIAN PRESIDENT PER CNN AND REUTERS COVERAGE CONTINUES TO GOVERN THE 60-DAY NEGOTIATION WINDOW, BUT THE FORMAL PUBLIC CEREMONY DID NOT TAKE PLACE

For FCI's energy and defense sleeves, the postponement is the principal new information the closed-Friday tape carries into Monday's open. Per the data drop, Brent (BNO) closed $\uparrow 0.90\%$ to \$43.88 and WTI (USO) $\uparrow 0.56\%$ to \$114.87 on Thursday — the reversal versus Wednesday's drift reflects, per Reuters coverage in the data drop's headlines (“Oil rises as uncertainty mounts over US-Iran truce”), the late-session tape reading the Bürgenstock no-show as reintroducing event risk into the Hormuz-reopen window. Per the Reuters exclusive cited in the data drop's headline run (“Iran's Revolutionary Guards set up covert Iraqi cells to attack Gulf neighbors, sources say”), an independent risk vector is reportedly being framed by intelligence sources as still active inside the framework window. For FCI's energy exposure (DVN $\downarrow 1.08\%$ to \$42.12, CVX $\downarrow 2.22\%$ to \$173.63, VLO $\downarrow 1.45\%$ to \$236.30, OKE $\downarrow 0.64\%$ to \$85.03, CNX $\downarrow 0.52\%$ to \$32.67 per the data drop), the cohort's Thursday weakness alongside the rebounding Brent tape suggests the equity complex is reading the deal optimism while the physical curve is repricing residual risk — the dispersion may compress on Monday in either direction depending on weekend developments. **The physical world matters.**

PER WSJ REPORTING CITED VIA REUTERS IN THE DATA DROP'S HEADLINE RUN, THE PENTAGON HAS REPORTEDLY TOLD U.S. LAWMAKERS IT NEEDS APPROXIMATELY \$80 BILLION TO COVER IRAN-WAR-RELATED AND OTHER BILLS PER DEPUTY DEFENSE SECRETARY STEPHEN FEINBERG, PER US NEWS & WORLD REPORT AND DECCAN HERALD COVERAGE — PER THE SAME COVERAGE, THE INITIAL \$200 BILLION REQUEST REPORTEDLY MET SIGNIFICANT CONGRESSIONAL OPPOSITION, AND DEFENSE OFFICIALS REPORTEDLY INDICATED THE MILITARY SERVICES COULD RUN OUT OF MONEY FOR OPERATIONS THIS SUMMER WITHOUT A NEW WARTIME SPENDING BILL — A FULL SUPPLEMENTAL REPORTEDLY INCLUDING DEFENSE, FARM, AND DISASTER RELIEF COULD REACH LAWMAKERS IN THE COMING DAYS

For FCI's defense sleeve (LMT $\downarrow 4.01\%$ to \$510.95, GD $\downarrow 3.53\%$ to \$350.01 per the data drop on Thursday's peace-deal reciprocal tape), the supplemental request is the analytical counterweight: the cohort's long-cycle backlog framework operates through the production-funding pipeline that a supplemental directly addresses, while the peace-deal narrative pressures near-term sentiment. Per the data drop's GD news run, Jefferies reportedly continues to see growth for the marine business and the SpaceX IPO has reportedly broadened the old-age space-defense ETF tape. The dispersion suggests the market is reading the framework execution and the supplemental request as discrete inputs rather than a

consolidated thesis — for the committee, the position-symmetric framework Carson has anchored continues to operate: a defense drawdown on a deal-execution print sits alongside a defense bid that may follow any supplemental progress, with the Bürgenstock no-show and the Pentagon ask both landing inside the closed-Friday window. Per Council on Foreign Relations coverage of the broader deal context, the underlying memorandum reportedly still governs the 60-day window despite Friday's ceremony postponement. **The physical world matters.**

BÜRGENSTOCK TALKS	Postponed per Swiss MFA · VP Vance dropped travel
MOU STATUS	Reportedly governs 60-day window per CNN/Reuters
IRAQI-CELL REUTERS EXCLUSIVE	IRGC reportedly set up Iraqi cells per Reuters sources
PENTAGON ASK	~\$80B for Iran war & other bills per WSJ via Reuters
BRENT (BNO) THU	\$43.88 · $\uparrow 0.90\%$ · reversal on uncertainty
WTI (USO) THU	\$114.87 · $\uparrow 0.56\%$
JUNETEENTH FRIDAY	NYSE, Nasdaq, full U.S. bond market closed · reopen Mon Jun 22

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — May PCE Lands Thursday June 25 at 8:30 AM ET per the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis Release

Calendar, the First Inflation Print of the Warsh Era After Wednesday's Hawkish Dot-Plot Revision. Per the BEA Personal Income and Outlays release calendar, the May 2026 read covering headline and core PCE prints next Thursday morning, framing the Monday-through-Wednesday tape as front-running. For FCI's rate-sensitive sleeves (TLT, the AI-infrastructure growth backbone, IBIT, ETHA), the print is the principal cross-asset variable into next week; per the prior brief cycle's coverage of the Warsh SEP, the dot-plot median moved to 3.8% from 3.4% in March per investingLive coverage of the FOMC release, raising the framing weight on the PCE trajectory. Per Kiplinger week-ahead coverage and the Federal Reserve calendar, next week also carries the standard Fed-speaker complex; communications under Warsh's reported "quieter Fed" framing per CNBC June 17 coverage may materially shift the read on each appearance. *Avoid Erosion.*

2. Week Ahead Earnings — Micron (MU) Reports Wednesday June 24 After the Close per Micron Investor Relations and StockTitan Coverage, With FedEx (FDX) Tuesday June 23 After the Close per FDX Coverage and Nike (NKE) Following Tuesday June 30 per Nike Investor Relations.

Micron is the principal AI-infrastructure read for the cohort the chip rip Thursday lifted — per the data drop's QCOM news headline ("Is The AI Super-Cycle Real Enough To Bet On Micron Stock?") and the broader memory-pricing tape, the print is expected to frame whether the foundry-driven move in TSM ↑6.94%, MRVL ↑7.27%, NXPI ↑5.05%, AMD ↑4.86%, and LRCX ↑3.97% per the data drop translates into a confirmed Q3 capex-cycle signal. FedEx Tuesday carries a secondary read on global goods flows into the May PCE print Thursday — per the data drop's TOL news run (TOL ↑4.02% to \$155.67 on new community openings), the housing complex continues to layer on the rate-sensitive sleeve's read into next week. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

3. The Bürgenstock Postponement Is the Principal Weekend Variable for the Monday Reopen.

Per Reuters, US News, and Times of Israel coverage cited in the data drop's headline run, the Friday talks were called off after VP Vance reportedly dropped travel plans; the underlying MOU reportedly still governs the 60-day window per CNN and CFR coverage. For FCI's energy sleeve, the Brent (BNO) reversal Thursday ($\uparrow 0.90\%$ to \$43.88) and the WTI (USO) print ($\uparrow 0.56\%$ to \$114.87) frame the physical complex as already repricing residual uncertainty; per the Reuters exclusive ("Iran's Revolutionary Guards set up covert Iraqi cells") layered onto the prior brief's Israel-Lebanon coverage, the discrete risk vectors remain active. Position-symmetric framework: DVN, CVX, OKE, VLO, CNX carry through a Brent compression scenario alongside cash-flow durability; LMT and GD carry through the supplemental-funding pipeline despite the peace-deal pressure. *Think Like an Owner.*

4. The Digital Sleeve Continued to Decouple to the Downside Thursday per the Data Drop.

IBIT $\downarrow 2.04\%$ to \$35.62, ETHA $\downarrow 1.45\%$ to \$12.88, COIN $\downarrow 1.00\%$ to \$163.26 against a tape where the broader chip cohort ripped $\uparrow 5\%$ – 9% reflects a divergence consistent with Bitcoin trading the Fed front-end repricing while equities traded the Iran-deal optimism. Per the data drop's holdings news run (COIN "5 Stocks to Sell as Cryptocurrencies Crumble"), the sentiment overlay reportedly remained cautious. Live Bitcoin reportedly traded in the low-\$60K area heading into Friday per multiple exchange feeds. For FCI's digital-rails complex, the Monday open carries the weekend Bitcoin tape, the Bürgenstock postponement, and the front-end repricing as three discrete catalysts — HOOD $\uparrow 2.80\%$ to \$108.15 Thursday per the data drop continued the relative strength even inside a broader digital drawdown, reportedly per the SpaceX IPO halo trade and the data drop's HOOD news run. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. STLD $\downarrow 7.49\%$ to \$249.91 Was the Single Largest Holdings-Specific Drawdown Thursday per the Data Drop.

Per StreetInsider, Investing.com, and PR Newswire coverage of the June 17 release, the company reportedly guided Q2 2026 EPS to \$3.51–\$3.55, reportedly below a consensus of approximately \$4.16, with the company reportedly citing an asset write-down on the Arizona-to-Mississippi recycled aluminum slab center relocation. The guide-down is a discrete print rather than a sector signal; per Seeking Alpha coverage cited in the search context, Nucor reportedly topped its own outlook, suggesting cohort dispersion rather than a unified steel-demand read. For the dividend sleeve, the STLD print stands against ADI $\uparrow 4.83\%$ to \$434.46 and CAT $\uparrow 3.13\%$ to \$985.82 per the data drop on the analog-recovery and capex-cycle tapes — the dispersion supports a name-specific rather than sleeve-wide framing for any Monday position-review. *Avoid Erosion.*

6. Carson's Active SPY \$645.80 Support Remains

Materially Untouched. Thursday's S&P 500 proxy range (\$743.86–\$748.23 per the data drop) carried well above Carson's framework, leaving the level as the committee's downside reference rather than an actionable near-term marker. The CNN Fear & Greed gauge sits in the "Fear" range per the live CNN endpoint as of the June 18 read at approximately 37 (the data drop's F&G fell back to the crypto index at 14 "Extreme Fear" per the workflow note), continuing to frame the recovery tape as occurring against cautious sentiment positioning rather than euphoric flow — the divergence between the chip-cohort rip and the Fear-zone sentiment read is itself a signal worth carrying into Monday's reopen. The position-symmetric framework remains anchored on Carson's level through the Juneteenth gap, the Bürgenstock postponement, and the May PCE print. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*